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September 2026
ENGLISH LANGUAGE 2 & 1
Essay and Objective
2 hours

2 &1

Name.....

Index Number.....

BEST BRAIN EXAMINATIONS KONSORTIUM

GHANA

Special Private Mock Examinations for BECE Candidates

September 2026 | ENGLISH LANGUAGE **2&1** ESSAY AND OBJECTIVE | 2 hours

Do **not** *open this booklet until you are told to do so. While you are waiting, read and observe the following instructions carefully. Write your* **name** *and* **index number** *in* **ink** *in the spaces provided above.*

This booklet consists of two papers. Answer Paper **2** *which comes first, in your answer booklet and Paper* **1** *on your Objective Test answer sheet. Paper* **2** *will last* **1** hour **15** minutes *after which the answer booklet will be collected. Do* **not** *start Paper* **1** *until you are told to do so. Paper* **1** *will last* **45** *minutes.*

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PAPER 2 1 hour 15 minutes

This Paper consists of **three** parts: **A, B and C.**
Answer **three** *questions in* **all;** **one** *question from* Part **A** *and* **all** *the questions in* Part **B** *and Part* **C.** *Answer all the questions in your answer booklet.*
Credit will be given for clarity of expression and orderly presentation of material.

PART A
WRITING
[30 marks]

Answer **one** *question* **only** *from this part.*
Your composition should be about **250** *words long.*

1. Many mining companies were recently found to be engaged in illegal mining (*galamsey*) in Ghana. Write a letter to the Minister for Lands and Natural Resources expressing your views on the activities of some mining companies. Suggest at least **three** measures the government can take to stop mining companies from engaging in galamsey.

2. Ghana has enjoyed peace for many years, but the rise in religious extremist activities could threaten this peace. Write a letter to your friend explaining the dangers of religious extremism and suggest **two** ways the government can prevent such activities.

3. Flooding has become a serious problem in many parts of Ghana, especially during the rainy season. Write an article for publication in a national newspaper discussing at least **three** causes of flooding and suggesting **three** practical ways to reduce the effects of flooding.

PART B
READING
[20 marks]

4. *Read the following passage carefully and answer* **all** *the questions which follow.*

The 2026 FIFA World Cup was a tournament of unusual scale and excitement. For the first time, 48 teams competed for football's most treasured prize instead of the 32 teams that competed in previous editions. The tournament was jointly hosted by Canada, Mexico and the United States, with matches spread across several cities. This expansion gave more teams the opportunity to test themselves against the best in the world. For some teams, qualification was already a remarkable achievement; for others, the real challenge was to prove they deserved to remain among the world's footballing elite.

The larger tournament came with enormous demands. Players and officials had to cope with long journeys, unfamiliar surroundings and pressure from millions of supporters. Coaches could not depend on only a few talented players. They had to manage their squads carefully because fatigue could affect performance as the competition progressed. A player who performed well in one match might not maintain the same level of performance. Careful preparation and effective use of players therefore became as important as individual skills.

For supporters, the World Cup offered experiences beyond the football pitch. Families gathered to watch matches, friends debated team strengths, and communities celebrated victories together. At

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viewing centres, strangers sometimes cheered side by side. The disappointment of defeat could be painful, yet it created memories that lasted for years. Football had the ability to bring people together and give them shared experiences long after matches ended. Even those far from stadiums followed the action through radio, television and social media.

The tournament also taught lessons about success and failure. A favourite team could lose by underestimating an opponent. Another team could grow stronger gradually through discipline and teamwork. Success could not always be predicted by the teams reputation. Players had to stay focused, learn from mistakes and use every opportunity well. The World Cup was therefore more than a contest for a trophy. It tested preparation, character, teamwork and determination under pressure. For young people, these lessons were valuable in school, at home and in future careers.

(a) Why was the qualification of some teams considered a remarkable achievement?
(b) State two difficulties players and officials faced during the tournament.
(c) Why was careful management of players important to coaches?
(d) "For supporters, the World Cup offered experiences that extended beyond the football pitch."
  (i) Mention one experience supporters enjoyed outside the football pitch.
  (ii) How did the World Cup bring strangers together?
(e) Explain, in your own words, the following expressions as used in the passage:
  (i) *football's most treasured prize,*
  (ii) *world's footballing elite,*
  (iii) *enormous demands,*
  (iv) *use every opportunity well.*
(f) For each of the following words, give another word or phrase that means **the same** and can **fit into** the passage:
  (i) tournament;
  (ii) remarkable;
  (iii) fatigue;
  (iv) disappointment;
  (v) underestimating;
  (vi) gradually;
  (vii) predicted;
  (viii) valuable.
(g) In **two** sentences of not more than **ten** words **each**, state **two** lessons the World Cup can teach.
(h) In **not** more than **eight** words, state how the World Cup unites people.

PART C
LITERATURE
[10 marks]

Answer **all** *the questions in this part.*

The questions are based on extracts from *The Beacon of Light.*

5. *Read the following extract carefully and answer Questions* **5**(a) *and* **5**(b).

PROSE: Kissiwaa the Heroine

"The argument heated up, with each player hurling insults. Old Soldier looked on in shock as the argument turned into a bitter shouting match. **(Pg. 13)**

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(a) What caused the argument between Kissiwaa and Bediako?

(b) What does Old Soldier's reaction reveal about his character?

Read the following extract carefully and answer Question 5(c) and 5(d)

PROSE: Oliver Asks for More

"But then, who named him Oliver?"
"I invented it," Mr Bumble said proudly. **(Pg. 5)**

(c) Who asked Mr. Bumble about Oliver's name?

(d) How did Mr. Bumble come up with names for the orphans?

Read the following extract carefully and answer Questions 5(e),5(f) and 5(g)

DRAMA: Spreading Light

Asantewaa: *(determined)* We can generate electricity for our village.
Iddrisu: You and your day-dreams. **(Pg. 187)**

(e) What does the word "*determined*" reveal about Asantewaa?

(f) What does Iddrisu mean by "day-dreams"?

(g) Iddrisu's response shows that he is.....

(h) One feature of drama found in the extract above is.....

Read the following extract carefully and answer Questions 5(i) and 5(j)

POETRY: The Unseen Painter

The very white canvas
Suddenly turned darker
God must be a painter

Changing dark and white sheets
Painting them bright with sunlight
And dark with the moon and twinkling stars

(Pg. 211)

(i) The expression "God must be a painter" is an example of.....

(j) (i) What does the "white canvas" represent?

(ii) What do the "dark and white sheets" refer to?

(iii) The central theme of the poem is.....

END OF ESSAY TEST

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Answer **all** *the questions.*

Each question is followed by **four** *options lettered* **A** *to* **D**. *Find the correct option for* **each** *question and shade* **in pencil** *on your answer sheet the space which bears the same letter as the option you have chosen. Give only* **one** *answer to* **each** *question. An example is given below.*

From the options **A** *to* **D**, *choose the one which* **most suitably completes** *the following sentence.*

I had better.....you about this issue.

A. saw
B. see
C. seen
D. seeing

The correct answer is see, *which is lettered* **B** *and therefore answer space* **B** *would be shaded.*

A [redacted] C D

Be sure you understand the instructions at the beginning of each section before you try to answer any of the questions that follow them.

Do **not** *spend too much time on a question. If you find a question difficult, leave it and go on to the next one, then come and try it again later.*

Use **pencil** *throughout. If you wish to change an answer, erase your first answer completely and shade the appropriate space for the new answer.*

Do all rough work in this question paper.

Now answer the following questions.

PART A
LEXIS AND STRUCTURE

SECTION A

Choose from the options **A** *to* **D**, *the one which* **most suitably completes** *each sentence.*

1. Not only the players but also the coach.....responsible for the defeat.
A. are
B. were
C. is
D. have been

2. Had the warning been taken seriously, the accident.....
A. would not occur.
B. would not have occurred.
C. will not have occurred.
D. did not occur.

3. I would rather Kojo.....the matter privately.
A. discusses
B. discussed
C. had discussed
D. discussing

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4. No sooner.....the bell rung than the pupils rushed out.
   A. had
   B. has
   C. did
   D. was

5. If I.....the opportunity to represent my school, I would do my very best.
   A. am given
   B. was given
   C. were given
   D. have been given

6. The students were asked to.....the information before making a decision.
   A. look down on
   B. look after
   C. look up to
   D. look into

7. Hardly had the bell rung.....the students rushed out of the classroom.
   A. than
   B. before
   C. then
   D. when

8. The woman bought a.....table for her dining room.
   A. beautifully crafted, wooden
   B. wooden, beautifully crafted
   C. beautifully craft, wooden
   D. wooden, beautifully craft

9. My brother is accustomed to.....early every morning.
   A. wake
   B. wakes
   C. waking
   D. woke

10. The two candidates blamed.....for the misunderstanding.
    A. one another
    B. themselves
    C. them
    D. each other

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11. The farmer could not harvest the crops because there was.....rain during the season.
   A. too many
   B. very few
   C. too little
   D. several

12. The prefect asked the students to keep the classroom clean, ...?
   A. didn't he
   B. wasn't he
   C. hadn't he
   D. doesn't he

13. It was.....difficult question that only a few candidates could answer it correctly.
   A. so
   B. such a
   C. such
   D. very a

From the options **A** *to* **D,** *what is the* **correct reported speech** *for the sentence in Question 14 below?*

14. "I will complete the assignment tomorrow," said Addae.

In reported speech, this becomes:

   A. Addae said that he will complete the assignment the next day.
   B. Addae said that he would complete the assignment the next day.
   C. Addae said that he would complete the assignment tomorrow.
   D. Addae says that he would complete the assignment the next day.

From the options **A** *to* **D,** *what is the* **correct passive form** *of the sentence in Question 15 below?*

15. The school authorities have awarded the best students full scholarships.
The best students.....full scholarships by the school authorities.

   A. were awarded
   B. are being awarded
   C. had been awarded
   D. have been awarded

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SECTION B

Choose from the options **A** *to* **D** *the one which is* **nearest in meaning** *to the underlined word in* **each** *sentence.*

16. The teacher was very <u>fastidious</u> about the arrangement of the books in the library.
- **A.** careless
- **B.** particular
- **C.** generous
- **D.** impatient

17. The doctor warned the villagers about the <u>pernicious</u> effects of drinking contaminated water.
- **A.** harmful
- **B.** temporary
- **C.** useful
- **D.** harmless

18. The <u>recalcitrant</u> student refused to obey the instructions given by the prefect.
- **A.** obedient
- **B.** frightened
- **C.** intelligent
- **D.** stubborn

19. With the dark clouds gathering, a heavy storm seemed <u>imminent</u>.
- **A.** unlikely
- **B.** distant
- **C.** approaching
- **D.** unexpected

20. The witness did not show an <u>iota</u> of fear during the questioning.
- **A.** a large amount
- **B.** a small amount
- **C.** a sudden feeling
- **D.** a clear sign

SECTION C

Choose from the options **A** *to* **D,** *the one that is* **most nearly opposite in meaning** *to the underlined word to fill the gap in each sentence.*

21. The editor decided to <u>abridge</u> the lengthy report, while the researcher chose to.....it.
- **A.** shorten
- **B.** expand
- **C.** correct
- **D.** simplify

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22. He introduced measures to mitigate the effects of the crisis, rather than.....the situation.
A. improve
B. prevent
C. worsen
D. control

23. The health officer advised residents to eschew unsafe water and.....clean drinking water.
A. reject
B. avoid
C. abandon
D. choose

24. The safety of the passengers is paramount, whereas other matters are considered.....
A. urgent
B. secondary
C. valuable
D. important

25. The reticent student shocked everyone by becoming quite.....during the debate.
A. reserved
B. silent
C. talkative
D. hesitant

SECTION D

In **each** *of the following sentences, a group of words has been underlined. Choose from the options* **A** *to* **D**, *the one that* **best explains** *the underlined group of words.*

26. The accountant was asked to crunch the numbers before the company made a decision. This means he was asked to.....
A. count the money.
B. analyse the figures.
C. reduce the expenses.
D. record the profits.

27. The first plan failed, so the team had to go back to the drawing board. This means they had to.....
A. abandon the project.
B. start planning again.
C. present the final plan.
D. change the workers.

28. After losing the final match, the players had the blues for several days. This means they.....
A. felt very sad.
B. became very angry.
C. refused to train.
D. celebrated quietly.

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29. The student's behaviour went off the rails after he joined the group.
This means that his behaviour.....
A. became unusual and uncontrolled.
B. improved considerably.
C. remained unchanged and untouched.
D. became more respectful.

30. The chairman jumped the gun by announcing the results before the votes were counted.
This means that he.....
A. made a quick decision.
B. acted too soon.
C. refused to accept the result.
D. changed the final result.

SECTION E

In the following passage, the numbered gaps indicate missing words. Against **each** *number in the list below the passage are* **four** *options arranged in columns lettered* **A** *to* **D**. *For each numbered gap, choose from the options provided, the word that is* **most suitable.**

When the school announced plans to establish a small library, the students were excited. However, the project initially faced several ---31--- because there was not enough money to buy books and furniture. The students decided to ---32--- funds by organising a reading competition and selling handmade items. Their efforts ---33--- the attention of some former students, who offered to support the project. With the additional help, the school was able to ---34--- the library with useful books and furniture. The headteacher expressed her appreciation and urged the students to ---35--- the facility properly.

	A	B	C	D
31.	complaints	arguments	failures	obstacles
32.	raise	rise	increase	grow
33.	gathered	collected	attracted	brought
34.	furnish	decorate	occupy	arrange
35.	maintain	preserve	protect	retain

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PART B
ORAL LANGUAGE

[UNIT I]

Choose from the options **A** *to* **D**, *the one which has the* ***same vowel sound*** *as the word underlined in the sentences below.*

36. The farmer had to <u>cut</u> the rope before it became dangerous.
- **A.** caught
- **B.** cot
- **C.** put
- **D.** blood

37. The mechanic asked me to <u>check</u> the engine carefully.
- **A.** cheque
- **B.** chick
- **C.** chill
- **D.** cake

[UNIT II]

Choose the word that contains the same long vowel sound as the underlined word.

38. The children were excited to visit the <u>zoo</u> during the holidays.
- **A.** book
- **B.** food
- **C.** zip
- **D.** blood

39. The athlete trained hard to <u>beat</u> his previous record.
- **A.** bread
- **B.** great
- **C.** seat
- **D.** head

[UNIT III]

Choose the word that contains the same diphthong sound as the underlined word.

40. The captain told the players to <u>stay</u> focused until the final whistle.
- **A.** said
- **B.** height
- **C.** great
- **D.** receive

END OF PAPER

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